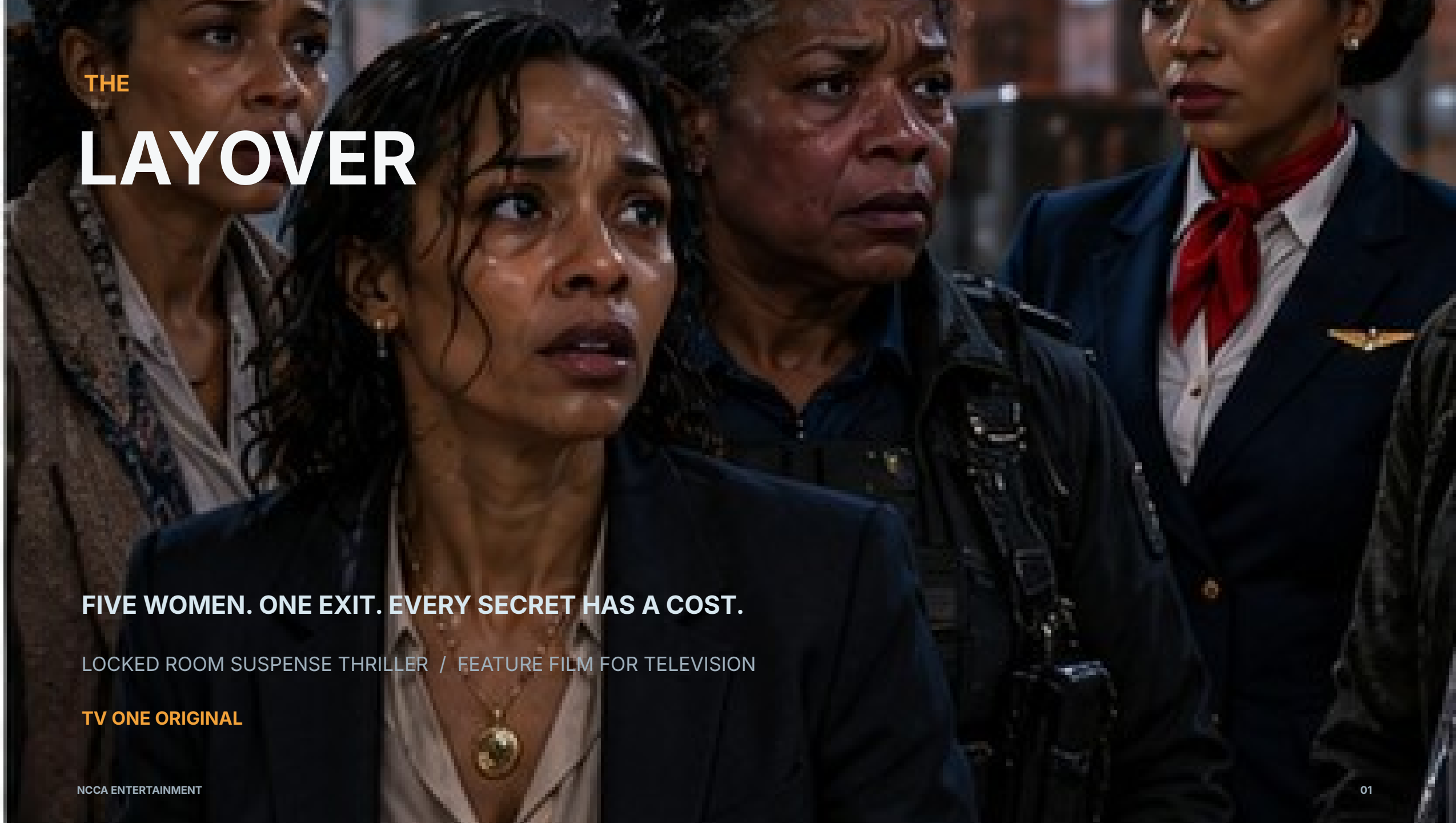


THE

LAYOVER

FIVE WOMEN. ONE EXIT. EVERY SECRET HAS A COST.

LOCKED ROOM SUSPENSE THRILLER / FEATURE FILM FOR TELEVISION

TV ONE ORIGINAL

Logline



During a historic Atlanta ice storm, five Black women trapped beneath the airport turn on one another when a federal witness's deadly secret surfaces and a carbon monoxide leak leaves them forty-five minutes to decide who deserves to escape.

ATLANTA • ONE NIGHT • NO CLEAN WAY OUT

The Hook

A contained thriller with the emotional weight of a reckoning

Five women enter the room with different ideas of power. Before dawn, every role changes.

A sealed industrial maze

Conveyors, frozen security grates, dead radios, and a failing ventilation system turn one airport bay into a pressure cooker.

A dead woman connects them

The witness, the hitwoman, and the hidden child share one wound. Each new truth changes who deserves protection.

A forty-five-minute clock

Carbon monoxide forces enemies to cooperate while a cartel cleaner waits for the perfect accidental death.



Tone and Comparables

Muscular suspense. Intimate moral drama. Restrained violence.



FROZEN INDUSTRIAL NOIR

Amber work lights, black conveyor mouths, wet steel, warning red, and ice-blue dawn.

BREAKDOWN

Relentless escalation inside an ordinary transit nightmare

THE GUILTY

A contained thriller driven by voice, guilt, and incomplete truth

WIDOWS

Black women with distinct motives, competence, and moral risk

FROZEN RIVER

Cold-weather desperation grounded in character and consequence





Monique Carter

38 / THE WITNESS

She can dismantle a cartel. First, she must tell the truth about the woman she left behind.

PERSONALITY

Exacting, hypervigilant, and fluent in the language of money and risk.

GOAL

Survive long enough to turn over the archive and protect Maya's daughter.

CONFLICT

Her immunity rests on a lie. The locket at her throat belongs to the friend she accidentally killed.

Kendra Vale

44 / THE CLEANER

She enters as comfort. She leaves every confession weaponized.

COVER

Airport crisis counselor with a voice made for trust.

MISSION

Recover the archive key, identify everyone with access, and stage the deaths as storm exposure.

PHILOSOPHY

Guilt is vanity performed by people who still need to believe they are good.



The Women in the Room

Every woman reads danger differently

DIANA COLE, 52

A veteran deputy marshal whose off-book trap turns her witness into bait.

SIMONE REED, 29

A contract killer hunting the truth about her missing sister, Maya.

PATRICIA BROWN, 64

A retired correctional officer racing to repair a three-year family rift.

NIA, 10

Maya's daughter, unseen but central to every choice Simone and Monique make.



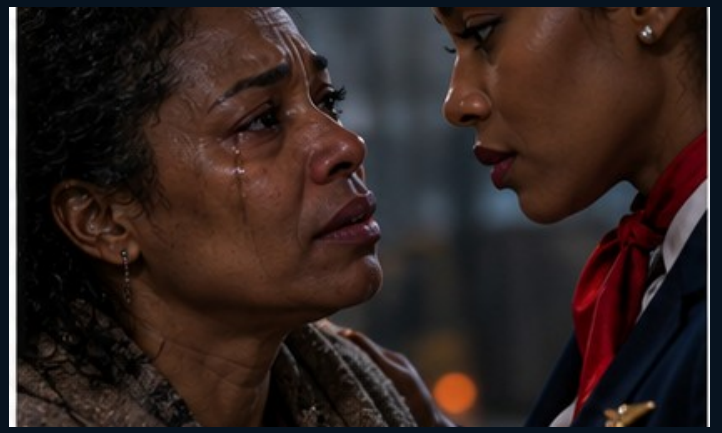
Story

Three acts of tightening pressure



ACT I / THE SEALED VAULT

Diana moves Monique through a monitored federal choke point as the airport freezes. The storm kills the cameras and locks Monique, Diana, Simone, Patricia, and Kendra inside. Simone's suppressed pistol hits the floor.



ACT II / THE INTERROGATION

Maya's locket exposes the bond between Monique and Simone. Monique admits she fired the fatal shot and fled. As carbon monoxide enters the bay, Patricia discovers Diana engineered the route.



ACT III / BLOOD AND CLEAR AIR

Kendra offers Simone revenge, but Simone chooses Maya's daughter over vengeance. The women carry a wounded Diana into the storm. Monique survives, then risks her immunity by amending her statement.

Visual World

Atlanta above. A steel courtroom below.







ICE BLUE

MIDNIGHT

EMERGENCY AMBER

WARNING RED

Wet concrete / Condensation / Rotating beacons / Security grates / Gold against steel

Casting Wishlist

A prestige ensemble with recognizable thriller authority

TEYONAH PARRIS	REGINA KING	KIKI LAYNE	ALFRE WOODARD	AUNJANUE ELLIS-TAYLOR
MONIQUE	DIANA	SIMONE	PATRICIA	KENDRA
CONTROLLED GUILT	AUTHORITY UNDER STRAIN	POLISHED DANGER	MORAL STEEL	WEAPONIZED EMPATHY

Casting references only. No talent is attached.

Why TV One

A suspense package built around character, consequence, and conversation

Five substantial roles for Black women across generations

Contained production footprint with cinematic airport scale

A clean thriller hook with restrained, consequential violence

Family repair and accountability deepen the survival engine

Distinct performances built for recognizable ensemble casting

A final moral choice designed to drive post-premiere conversation



Materials and Next Steps

AVAILABLE

- ✓ Revised TV One treatment
- ✓ Tight logline and buyer positioning
- ✓ 16:9 key art concept
- ✓ Character and visual direction

NEXT

01 Screenplay rewrite to 80–85 pages

02 Casting conversations and director shortlist

03 Budget, schedule, and location plan

04 Buyer-facing verbal pitch and submission package

THE LAYOVER

When the doors lock, the truth becomes the only way out.